

What the System Remembers: A Signal

系统记住了什么：一个信号

Theme: 科学、技术与互联网 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The club had finally agreed to pay for rest; the next failure was in a system that never slept. The seventh arc opened with a **signal** that nobody had asked for: a **download** of the club's **website** that included a file nobody had uploaded. The **board** took one **look** at the log, and the **third** member of the team, a **base** of operations in the innovation lab, was asked to explain the **exposure**. "It is a **delay** in the wrong **direction**," Aisha said. "It is a **resource** problem, not a **wish** problem."

The **aim** was a **reduction** in the **concentration** of personal data on the server. A **video** of a training session, a **cookie** in the browser, and an **echo** of an old backup were the only things anyone could find. "**Take** the **filter** and the **bearing** off the machine," the **officer** said. "**Make** the **composition** of the file smaller." **Indeed**, the file was a **compound** of six unrelated documents.

The **projection** was worse than the **delay**: a **microphone** left on during a massage, a **fax** to the wrong office, and a **kettle** of water boiling beside a **microwave**. "A **logo** is not proof of anything," Maya said. "An **omission** is." The **side** of the lab that held the servers was the **side** nobody could enter without a **boot** on each foot.

The **biology** of the problem was a **charm** and a **jaw**. "**Biology** is not the issue," the **biochemical** engineer said. "The issue is that we cannot **take** a **volt** of trust and charge it to a customer." The **imperial** habit of shipping a product first and asking later had to be broken; the **mount** of documents, the **swing** of the **curve**, and the **exposure** all pointed the same way.

The **reflection** that followed was short. "We **bring** the **situation** to the **board** and **take** the **possible offer**," Lin wrote. "We **place** the note in the register and **send** the same message to everyone." The **might** of a small team is its willingness to show the file before someone else does. The **board**, the **officer**, and the **situation** on the server all pointed to the same **place**: we **might bring** the **offer**, **take** the **place**, and **make** it **possible** to **send** a smaller file. A **wish** is not a plan; **indeed**, the **look** on the **officer's** face said that the **cause** of the leak was still unknown. The **focus** of the **pass** was simple: **down** the list, item by item, we would **eat** the **fat** of the file, **take** the **barrier** out of the **exhaust** pipe, and let the **notation** in the margin **involve** every reader.

中文翻译

俱乐部终于同意为休息付钱；而下一次失败，出现在一个从不睡觉的系统里。第七段弧线以一个没人要求的信号开始：俱乐部网站的一次下载，里面包含了一个没人上传过的文件。董事会只看了一眼日志，团队的第三位成员——创新实验室里的一个行动基地——就被要求解释这次暴露。“这是方向错误的延误，”艾莎说，“这是资源问题，不是愿望问题。”

目标是降低服务器上个人数据的集中度。一段训练录像、浏览器里的一块饼干，以及一次旧备份的回声，是任何人都能找到的全部东西。“把过滤器和方位从机器上拿下来，”官员说，“把文件的构成变小。”的确，那个文件是六份不相关文档的化合物。

预测比延误更糟：按摩时忘关的麦克风、发错办公室的传真，以及在微波炉旁烧开的水壶。“标志不能证明任何事，”曼雅说，“遗漏才能。”实验室里存放服务器的那一侧，是没有人能不穿靴子走进去的一侧。

这个问题的生物学部分是一份魔力和一个下颌。“生物学不是问题所在，”生物化学工程师说，“问题在于我们不能取一伏特的信任，然后把它记在客户账上。”那种先发货、后询问的帝国式习惯必须被打破；文件的架、曲线的摆动，以及这次暴露，都指向同一个方向。

随之而来的反思很短。“我们把情况带到董事会，接受任何可能的提议，”林伟写道，“把说明放进登记簿，并把同样的消息发给每个人。”一支小团队的力量，就在于它愿意在别人之前先把文件拿出来。董事会、那位官员，以及服务器上的情况，都指向同一个地方：我们可以把提议带过去，把位置接过来，并让发一个更小的文件成为可能。一个愿望不是计划；的确，那位官员脸上的表情说明，泄漏的原因仍然不明。这一轮梳理的重点很简单：顺着清单，一项一项地把文件里的肥肉吃掉，把排气管里的障碍取出来，并让页边的标注涉及每一位读者。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
down daʊn POS: a	a. 向下的; adv. 下, 下去, 降下; prep. 往下, 沿着; n. 丘陵, 软毛, 开阔的高地; [计] 向下, 退下命令 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. soft fine feathers; n. (American football) a complete play to advance the football; n. English physician who...
pass pæs POS: n	n. 经过, 要隘, 途径, 通行, 护照, 及格; vt. 经过, 越过, 通过, 批准, 度过, 传递, 忽略; vi. 经过, 变化, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (military) a written leave of absence; n. (American football) a play that involves one player throwing the...
third θɜ:d POS: num	num. 第三, 三分之一; [机] 第三; 第三的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. following the second position in an ordering or series; n. the musical interval between one note and anothe...
base beɪs POS: n	n. 底部, 垒, 基础, 基地; vt. 以...作基础; a. 卑鄙的, 低劣的; [计] 基准 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. installation from which a military force initiates operations; n. a place that the runner must touch before...
focus ˈfəʊkəs POS: n	n. 焦点, 焦距; vi. 聚焦, 注视; vt. 使聚焦, 调焦, 集中; [计] 焦点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the concentration of attention or energy on something; n. maximum clarity or distinctness of an image rende...
resource rɪˈsɔ:s POS: n	n. 资源, 财力, 办法, 策略, 急智, 消遣; [计] 资源 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. available source of wealth; a new or reserve supply that can be drawn upon when needed; n. a source of aid...
direction dɪˈrekʃən POS: n	n. 方向, 指导, 趋势; [计] 方向; 流向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a line leading to a place or point; n. the spatial relation between something and the course along which it...
video ˈvɪdiəʊ POS: n	n. 影像, 电视; a. 图像的, 电视的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the visible part of a television transmission; n. (computer science) the appearance of text and graphics on...
aim eɪm POS: n	n. 目标, 瞄准, 击中目标的能力; vi. 对准目标, 致力, 打算; vt. 瞄准; [计] 医学文摘索引, 存取隔离机构, 高级信息管理... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the goal intended to be attained (and which is believed to be attainable); n. the action of directing somet...
reduction rɪˈdʌkʃən POS: n	n. 减少, 缩影, 变化; [化] 还原 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any process in which electrons are added to an atom or ion (as by removing oxygen or adding hydrogen); alw...
concentration ˌkɒnsənˈtreɪʃən POS: n	n. 集中, 专心; [化] 浓度; 浓缩 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the strength of a solution; number of molecules of a substance in a given volume; n. the spatial property o...
fat fæt POS: n	n. 脂肪, 脂油, 肥肉; a. 肥的, 胖的, 油腻的; n. 文件分配表; [计] 文件分配表 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a soft greasy substance occurring in organic tissue and consisting of a mixture of lipids (mostly triglyce...
signal ˈsɪɡnəl POS: n	n. 信号, 暗号, 近因, 导火线; vt. 向...作信号, 标志, 用信号通知; vi. 发信号; a. 作为信号的, 显著的; [计] 信号 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any nonverbal action or gesture that encodes a message; n. any incitement to action; n. an electric quantity...
boot bu:t POS: n	n. 长靴, 踢, 解雇, 效用; vt. 使穿靴, 踢, 解雇, 有用; [计] 引导, 自举 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. footwear that covers the whole foot and lower leg; n. British term for the luggage compartment in a car; n. ...
exposure ɪkˈspəʊʒə POS: n	n. 暴露, 揭发, 揭露; [化] 曝光量; 照射; 照射量 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. vulnerability to the elements; to the action of heat or cold or wind or rain; ; n. the act of subjecting so...
swing swɪŋ POS: n	n. 摇摆, 振幅, 韵律, 节奏, 涨落, 秋千, 旋转, 行动自由; vi. 摇摆, 悬挂, 旋转, 大摇大摆地走, 转向; vt. 挥舞... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of steady vigorous action that is characteristic of an activity; n. mechanical device used as a pla...
curve kə:v POS: n	n. 曲线, 弯曲, 曲线球; vt. 弯, 使弯曲; vi. 成曲形 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the trace of a point whose direction of motion changes; n. a line on a graph representing data; n. a pitch o...
delay dɪˈleɪ POS: n	n. 耽搁, 迟滞; v. 耽搁, 延迟; [计] 延迟, 延时 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. time during which some action is awaited; n. the act of delaying; inactivity resulting in something being p...
mount maʊnt POS: n	n. 乘骑用马, 框, 衬纸, 山; vi. 乘马, 爬上, 增长; vt. 爬上, 使上马, 装上, 装裱, 安放, 制作...的标本, 设... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mounting consisting of a piece of metal (as in a ring or other jewelry) that holds a gem in place; v. att...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
barrier 'bæriə POS: n	n. 障碍, 栅栏; [化] 势垒; 阻片; 阻挡层 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a structure or object that impedes free movement; n. any condition that makes it difficult to make progress...
reflection ri'flekʃən POS: n	n. 反映, 沉思, 映像, 想法, 责难; [计] 反射 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the phenomenon of a propagating wave (light or sound) being thrown back from a surface; n. the image of som...
composition kəmpe'ziʃən POS: n	n. 作文, 创作, 组成; [化] 成分; 组成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the spatial property resulting from the arrangement of parts in relation to each other and to the whole; n. ...
imperial im'piəriəl POS: a	a. 帝王的, 宗主国的, 至尊的, 壮丽的; n. 特等品 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a small tufted beard worn by Emperor Napoleon III; n. a piece of luggage carried on top of a coach; a. relat...
cookie 'kuki POS: n	n. 饼干, 小甜点; [建] 糕点 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any of various small flat sweet cakes ('biscuit' is the British term); n. the cook on a ranch or at a camp; ...
echo 'ekəu POS: n	n. 回声, 回音, 回波; vt. 发回声, 随声附和; vt. 摹仿, 重复, 反射; [计] 回显; DOS批处理命令:控制MS-DOS命... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the repetition of a sound resulting from reflection of the sound waves; n. (Greek mythology) a nymph who wa...
compound kəm'paund POS: n	n. 混合物, 复合词, 化合物, 院子; a. 复合的, 混合的, 化合的; vi. 化合, 和解, 妥协; vt. 使复合, 使化合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a whole formed by a union of two or more elements or parts; n. (chemistry) a substance formed by chemical u...
filter 'filtə POS: n	n. 滤波器, 过滤器, 滤光器, 过滤嘴, 去尘器; vt. 过滤, 渗透, 走漏; vi. 滤过, 渗入; [计] 过滤器, 筛选 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. device that removes something from whatever passes through it; n. an electrical device that alters the freq...
jaw dʒɔ: POS: n	n. 颞, 颌; v. 闲谈, 教训, 唠叨 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the part of the skull of a vertebrate that frames the mouth and holds the teeth; n. the bones of the skull...
biology baɪ'blɒdʒi POS: n	n. 生物学; [化] 生物; 生物学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the science that studies living organisms; n. characteristic life processes and phenomena of living organis...
charm tʃɑ:m POS: n	n. 吸引力, 魔力, 符咒; vt. 迷住, 使陶醉, 行魔法; vi. 用符咒, 有魅力 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something believed to bring good luck; n. (physics) one of the six flavors of quark; v. control by magic spe...
exhaust ig'zɔ:st POS: n	n. 排气, 排气装置, 废气; vt. 抽完, 用尽, 耗尽, 使精疲力尽; vi. 排气 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. gases ejected from an engine as waste products; n. system consisting of the parts of an engine through whic...
projection prə'dʒekʃən POS: n	n. 发射, 计划, 突出部分, 设计, 推测; [计] 投影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a prediction made by extrapolating from past observations; n. the projection of an image from a film onto a...
website phonetic unavailable POS: n	n. 网站 (全球资讯网的主机站) Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a computer connected to the internet that maintains a series of web pages on the World Wide Web
bearing 'beəriŋ POS: n	n. 举止, 轴承, 忍受, 关系, 意义, 方向, 生育; [化] 轴承 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. relevant relation or interconnection; n. the direction or path along which something moves or along which i...
microphone 'maɪkrəfəʊn POS: n	n. 扩音器, 麦克风; [医] 扩音器, 传声器 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. device for converting sound waves into electrical energy
fax fæks POS: n	n. 传真; vt. 发传真; [计] 传真系统; 传真 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. send something via a facsimile machine
kettle 'ketl POS: n	n. 茶壶, 罐; [化] 釜体釜; 锅 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a metal pot for stewing or boiling; usually has a lid; n. the quantity a kettle will hold; n. a large hemisp...
microwave 'maɪkrəweɪv POS: n	n. 微波; [计] 微波 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a short electromagnetic wave (longer than infrared but shorter than radio waves); used for radar and micro...
logo 'ləʊgəu POS: n	n. 连合活字, 商标, 徽标; [计] 徽标 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a company emblem or device
omission əu'mɪʃən POS: n	n. 省略, 遗漏, 疏忽; [化] 省略 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a mistake resulting from neglect; n. something that has been omitted; n. any process whereby sounds or words...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
download phonetic unavailable POS: review required	[计] 卸载, 下载 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. transfer a file or program from a central computer to a smaller computer or to a computer at a remote loca...
notation neu'teɪjən POS: n	n. 记号, 符号表示法, 注释; [计] 记数法 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a technical system of symbols used to represent special things; n. the activity of representing something b...
biochemical .baɪəu'kemɪkl POS: a	a. 生物化学的; [机] 生物化学的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or relating to biochemistry; involving chemical processes in living organisms
volt vəʊlt POS: n	n. 伏特; [化] 伏特 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a unit of potential equal to the potential difference between two points on a conductor carrying a current...
upload 'ʌp,ləʊd POS: review required	[计] 上装, 加载, 储入 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. transfer a file or program to a central computer from a smaller computer or a computer at a remote location